

War of the worlds:

The battle of good vs. evil



Nature is the best teacher and a geeky nut the best pupil. Computer viruses are no more the childish projects of teenage kids who fancy themselves to be geeks. At the time the first viruses were invented, they were exactly that, but now they are the weapons of war and as potent in the

Antivirus suites are the white knights in this invisible war and their goal is simple, to protect their master and repel that creature. Not all knights are created equal and not all are noble. Some are only here for the money, others for power. Sometimes it's these knights that propagate tales of war and woe and unmatched heroism; tales that will keep the knaves



An underground war is being waged online

virtual world as any biological weapon created by man. These weapons are more subtle, they surreptitiously sneak into the system, enslave your system and its resources to the vast network of some hacker, who's sitting in some corner of the world keeping this writhing, pulsating creature alive, just waiting to unleash its potential on some unsuspecting victim. This is the battlefield of today. A world where no lives are lost but where everything is just a game and the PCs involved, just pawns.

in check and gain the favour of the masses. There is a very grave threat looming over this war, the threat of efficiency and absolute monarchies that control the world's most coveted resources with an iron fist. These monarchies are involved in a struggle of their own, which is slowing down their progress, but their dominance is inevitable. The dark ages (or the age of light, depending on your perspective) are coming.

This threat is the advent of the application store. Apple's App store, Google's

Play Store, Ubuntu's software centre and even the Windows Marketplace. These stores are doing their best to eliminate malware at the roots. The face of the PC has changed; the needs of the times identified and the desire of the masses fulfilled. Apps are now getting more and more centralised; all the apps on these stores have to pass through a rigorous checklist before they're approved.

What this does, other than presenting a user with a centralized app store, is eliminate most malware, drastically reduce the chance of infecting a PC because of some obscure "Oh no! Your PC is infected! CLICK HERE TO CLEAN" type of pop-up. Right now these stores are too restricted and a real PC user shuns them like the plague, but they have shown their potential.

Such stores will not only eliminate traditional malware, but they'll also eliminate traditional antivirus suites. Even now these suites are desperately struggling to evolve and adapt to a market that may not need them anymore. Stores that are a bit lax when it comes to screening, such as the Play Store, have developed a reputation for harbouring malware and it won't be long before something is done about that reputation and fast.

The OS is also evolving to eliminate such threats. While Windows 8 may have received a lot of flak for its design, the core of that OS, the venerable NT kernel, is the one that requires the most attention. Windows wasn't the target of viruses just because it was popular, that's only part of the story. The OS was attacked because it could be attacked. Other Operating Systems such as Android, iOS and Mac OS are far more secure and even creating a

